

CLAUDE CODE

Agent teams in Claude Code

Stop running one overloaded agent. Run a team — in parallel, each in its own clean context.

THE GAP

Why it matters

One agent + a huge task = a polluted context and worse answers. Subagents each get a SEPARATE context window, so the main thread stays sharp.

01 · SETUP

Create a teammate

Run `/agents`, or drop a Markdown file in your repo. Commit it and the whole team shares it.

- `.claude/agents/code-reviewer.md`
- frontmatter: name, description, tools, model

02 · HOW IT WORKS

It delegates for you

Claude reads each agent's description and routes matching work to it — or you call it by name.

- 'Use the code-reviewer subagent'
- Auto-delegates on a matching description

03 · THE UNLOCK

Run them in parallel

Ask for several at once. They run concurrently, each isolated, and the results merge in your main thread.

- 'Review this PR with 3 subagents:
- security, performance, tests'

04 · COST & SAFETY

Right tool, right model

Scope each agent so it's cheap where it can be and safe where it must be.

- Reviewer → tools: Read, Grep (no Write)
- Finder → model: haiku (cheap)
- Architect → model: opus

05 · BUILT-IN AGENTS

You already have a team

Three ship by default: Explore (fast, read-only search), Plan (read-only research), general-purpose (full tools).

IN THE WILD

A real build

We shipped a full app this way: 1 agent set the shared contracts → 3 agents built modules in parallel → a QA agent reviewed and looped fixes until green.

KEEP IT REAL

Know the limits

Subagents can't spawn their own subagents, and they don't share state — they coordinate through the main thread. Perfect for parallel work, not chatty back-and-forth.



DO THIS TODAY

Start with one.

Create a read-only code-reviewer subagent and run it after your next change. Then add a parallel test-runner. Save this for setup.

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